

09-09-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OIJKeLPRdw8
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Target Category	mcs

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Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Community Schools (MCS) Board of Trustees was called to order [00:03:10](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heater, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Dr. Washburn, Mr. Irvin, and Mr. Le.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in transcript dialogue, though led by the board president/chair.

Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence [00:03:10](#) followed by the Pledge of Allegiance [00:03:22](#). The board congratulated Mr. Irvin on becoming a grandfather [00:03:58](#). Three Muncie Central High School seniors (Clayton, Co, and Lexi) and parent Christina were recognized for observing the meeting [[00:03:53](#), [00:09:56](#), [01:13:25](#)].
- **Approval of Minutes:** *Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text.*

Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:13:46](#) Consent Agenda

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Presiding Officer / Mr. Derome
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed the consent agenda, which included donations to the Panther Pantry from Raymond James, Community Business Connections, Parsons Morrow Mortuary, and JRTC in memory of Madison Workman 00:14:11.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:14:07.

00:14:48 August Financial Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome (Chief Financial Officer)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the August financial results, cash balances, and state revenue updates. Enrollment projections sit around 4,908 (currently 688 headcount), with a state basic grant revenue of \$47.6 million (\$600,000 higher than last year). The total cash balance stands at over \$32 million. Bond sales are scheduled for October 16th (\$10 million) to fund current planning projects.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:18:18.

00:18:25 Extracurricular Activity (ECA) Compensation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Heater / Compensation Committee
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presented minor changes for the 2025<U+2013>2026 school year pay rates, including adjusting non-certified tutoring to \$16.50/hour and student tutoring to \$12/hour, adding an assistant middle school soccer position if participation exceeds 40, and adding an assistant coach for girls wrestling due to IHSA sanctioning.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:22:52.

00:22:56 Support Staff Compensation Recommendations

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Compensation Committee / Mr. Derome / Dr. Reynolds
- **Deliberation Summary:** Recommendations represent a \$111,000 increase in compensation (approx. 1.3% increase on last year's budget). The plan continues retention stipends of up to \$1,500 per support staff member, distributed in three installments (September 20, December 20, and May 20) to improve retention.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:28:18.

00:28:23 Strategic Plan (2025<U+2013>2028)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Williams / Dr. Reynolds / Consultant Dr. Quacowski
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed the new three-year implementation strategic plan built on two foundational pillars (student success; continuous, aligned, and strategic

professional learning) and five strategic initiatives (high-quality pre-K, recruitment/retention of educational leaders, student-centered teaching/active learning including the Camp Adventure Montessori program, social-emotional learning, and family/community engagement). Staff retention has reached 84<U+2013>85%.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:34:39](#).

[00:34:47 2026 Budget Adoption & Resolutions](#)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of the 2026 budget, tax levy, capital project plan, and bus replacement plan. Five resolutions were brought forward for adoption: (1) 2026 capital project plan, (2) 2026 bus replacement plan, (3) Line one and line two reduction authority (allowing reductions for DLGF audit adjustments), (4) State adoption ordinance form, and (5) Encumbrances approval. Board leadership also warned of looming structural deficits in the operations fund by 2028 due to state tax caps (Senate Bill 1) and textbook funding formula shifts.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved in the aggregate by Voice Vote [00:38:10](#).

[Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum](#)

- *No open public comment period or public speakers addressed the board during this meeting.*

[Administrative Updates & Adjournment](#)

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Superintendent Dr. Reynolds highlighted upcoming events: the Educational Professional Development Summit on September 19th with keynote speaker Cousin Danny [00:04:30](#), parent-teacher conferences with two-hour early release days on September 25th and 26th [00:04:44](#), Muncie Fieldhouse hosting the Boys 4A North Semi-State in March [00:07:10](#), the MCS Education Foundation website launch [00:07:57](#), and the Community Engagement Council cornhole fundraiser tournament at Minatrista on September 20th [00:08:48](#).
 - Board members announced upcoming attendance at the Indiana School Board Association conference [00:45:42](#).
 - **Adjournment:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:46:18](#).
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